

5.2 Nervous control

Co-ordination may be chemical or electrical in nature. In this section, learners gain an understanding of the electrical component through the study of the structure and functions of the mammalian nervous system. The use of brain scanning techniques and traditional reflex tests to assess brain injury are investigated. An appreciation of the unique problems associated with damage to neurones is considered, as well as the effects of histological changes in the nervous system as a result of ageing.

The effects of drugs on the nervous system are also considered, including their use in the treatment of neurological conditions such as Parkinson's disease.

The eye is used to illustrate the role of the sensory receptor as a biological transducer. The use of optical scans and eye tests to assess visual function is also explored.

Learners are expected to apply knowledge, understanding and other skills gained in this section to new situations and/or to solve related problems.